

PHISHING EMAIL INCIDENT REPORT

1. INCIDENT OVERVIEW

INCIDENT TYPE:

Phishing Email

SEVERITY:

Medium

VERDICT:

Malicious / Phishing

CONFIDENCE:

High

SUMMARY:

A user reported a suspicious email impersonating Microsoft Security. The email attempted to create urgency and direct the recipient to a suspicious account verification URL.

2. EMAIL DETAILS

SENDER:

security-alert@micros0ft-support.com

REPLY-TO:

security-verification@micros0ft-support.com

SUBJECT:

URGENT: Unusual Sign-In Activity Detected

SUSPICIOUS DOMAIN:

micros0ft-support.com

SUSPICIOUS URL:

<https://micros0ft-support.com/verify>

3. INVESTIGATION FINDINGS

SENDER ANALYSIS:

The sender domain is a Microsoft lookalike domain. The domain uses "micros0ft"

with the number "0" replacing the letter "o".

HEADER ANALYSIS:

SPF: FAIL

DKIM: NONE

DMARC: FAIL

These results indicate that the email failed important sender authentication checks.

URL ANALYSIS:

The URL uses the same lookalike domain and contains a "/verify" path that could be used for credential harvesting.

THREAT INTELLIGENCE:

VirusTotal reported 0/92 detections for the domain.

The absence of threat-intelligence detections does not prove that the domain

is legitimate. The domain remains suspicious based on the other indicators.

4. PHISHING INDICATORS

- Microsoft brand impersonation
- Lookalike domain
- Failed SPF authentication
- Failed DMARC authentication
- No DKIM signature
- Suspicious verification URL
- Urgent language
- Account restriction threat
- Potential credential harvesting

5. INDICATORS OF COMPROMISE

SENDER:

security-alert@micros0ft-support.com

REPLY-TO:

security-verification@micros0ft-support.com

DOMAIN:

micros0ft-support.com

URL:

<https://micros0ft-support.com/verify>

IP ADDRESS:

Not identified

FILE HASH:

Not identified

6. MITRE ATT&CK MAPPING

T1566.002 - PHISHING: SPEARPHISHING LINK

The email uses a suspicious link to direct the recipient toward a potentially malicious verification page.

T1583.001 - ACQUIRE INFRASTRUCTURE: DOMAINS

The scenario demonstrates the use of a suspicious lookalike domain for impersonation.

7. SOC RESPONSE RECOMMENDATIONS

- ✓ Quarantine the phishing email.
- ✓ Block the identified domain and URL.
- ✓ Search email logs for other recipients.
- ✓ Determine whether the user clicked the URL.
- ✓ Check whether credentials were submitted.
- ✓ Reset credentials if compromise is suspected.
- ✓ Monitor the affected account for suspicious activity.

8. FINAL ASSESSMENT

- The email is assessed as a phishing attempt with high confidence based on
- multiple correlated indicators.
- The strongest indicators are the Microsoft lookalike domain, failed SPF and
- DMARC authentication, suspicious verification URL, and social-engineering
- techniques.
- The investigation demonstrates a basic SOC L1 phishing email investigation
- workflow involving email analysis, header analysis, URL analysis, IOC
- extraction, threat intelligence, and incident documentation.